# The Dhāraṇī of the Ten Grounds

Daśabhūmidhāraṇī · Toh 902 · Derge Kangyur
ས་བཅུའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī of the Ten Grounds, known in Sanskrit as the Daśabhūmidhāraṇī and in Tibetan by a title meaning "the dhāraṇī of the ten grounds," is a short tantric text that explains how practitioners of secret mantra can fulfill their aims. It links the single syllable oṃ to the maṇḍalas of Amoghapāśa Padmoṣṇīṣa, a form of Avalokiteśvara, the Lord of the World. It teaches that reciting the mantra a hundred thousand times in his presence brings one to the first of the ten bodhisattva grounds. The recitation is said to destroy the hells awaiting those burdened by past evil, as wind scatters dust, and to bring every accomplishment and please all the tathāgatas and maṇḍala deities. The work is Toh 902 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the incantations and spells gathered in the canon's dhāraṇī collection.

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In the language of India: daśabhūmidhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī of the Ten Grounds.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Next comes how those who enter the secret mantra will accomplish each and every one of their aims. The single-syllable secret mantra called oṃ belongs to all the maṇḍalas of Amoghapāśa Padmoṣṇīṣa. When one has recited it a hundred thousand times in the presence of the Lord of the World, one will abide on the first ground. Beings who have accumulated evil in the past may be bound for any of the unbearable hells, whichever they may be. All of those hells will be destroyed, just as the wind scatters dust. One will obtain all accomplishments. All aims will follow along. All the tathāgatas, and whatever other deities of the maṇḍala there are, will be pleased, and noble Avalokiteśvara will always grant the supreme boon. One who dies having recited the secret mantra called oṃ will go to the world realm of Sukhāvatī. This is the single-syllable secret mantra.

oṃ bhuḥ

If one recites this two-syllable mantra a hundred thousand times, one will obtain the qualities of the second ground. One will dwell in the presence of the Tathāgata Amitābha, and he will grant every supreme boon. He will also purify all evil deeds. Illness caused by former bad karma will also be cured. The son

of Maṇibhadra, the lord of wealth, will come under one's control and stay close by. No human being whatsoever will ever again be able to create obstacles. After death, one will be reborn on Potalaka. One will also obtain the accomplishment of Amoghapāśa. This is the two-syllable mantra.

oṃ padme

Having recited the three-syllable secret mantra a hundred thousand times, one will properly enter the third ground. One will be initiated into all the mudrās and secret mantras of the maṇḍala of the Vast Lotus. Noble Avalokiteśvara, in the form of a youth, will be present before one. He will grant the supreme fulfillment of all desires. He will reveal the maṇḍala of Amoghapāśa Padmoṣṇīṣa. He will reveal the secret maṇḍalas of all the tathāgatas. He will grant accomplishments in every respect. This is the three-syllable mantra.

oṃ padma hrīḥ

Having recited the four-syllable secret mantra a hundred thousand times, one will enter the fourth ground. The noble Tathāgata Akṣobhya, his body the color of gold, will be present before one. Extending his arm, he will place his hand on the crown of one's head and bestow on the vidyādhara the word "Excellent," saying: "Vidyādhara, come here! All your evil deeds and obscurations are purified. Your whole nature is completely purified and utterly stainless. When you pass from this human world, you will come to my buddha field and remember your past lives. Never again will you be sullied by dwelling in a womb. All your worldly aims will be accomplished." This is the fourth ground.

oṃ padma bhuje

Having recited the five-syllable secret mantra a hundred thousand times, one will abide on the fifth ground. The Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Padmottara will reveal himself. All obscurations will be completely exhausted. He will give the vidyādhara the sound of "Excellent," saying: "Vidyādhara, excellent, excellent! A great heap of merit has arisen for you. Vidyādhara, because you have generated great roots of virtue, Vidyādhara, after you die you will generate incomparable roots of virtue in the presence of ninety-two koṭis of niyutas of tathāgatas, and you will be born in my buddha field. You will accomplish the heart of Amoghapāśa Padmoṣṇīṣa, the secret maṇḍala, and the detailed stages of the great mudrā. Vidyādhara, abandon all evil deeds and obscurations and perform every rite! All the practices you set

your mind on will be fully accomplished, every one of them, just as you wish." This is the fifth ground.

oṃ padma lokite

If one recites the six-syllable dhāraṇī-mantra a hundred thousand times, one will obtain and enter the sixth ground. All the tathāgatas will illuminate one. Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas as numerous as the atoms of a great trichiliocosm will look upon one, reveal themselves directly, and give reassurance. Then the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Banner of the Lotus Gaze will reassure that vidyādhara, saying: "Vidyādhara, come here to my buddha field, until you finally reach the heart of awakening. The karma you have created is entirely exhausted. You have closed the doors of hell for beings. You have opened the doors of all the buddha fields. You have understood the seed and the common family of the tathāgatas. You have accomplished the heart of Amogha Padmoṣṇīṣa and the secret maṇḍala. Since you have opened the doors to the abodes everywhere, perform all the rites that accomplish worldly and transworldly aims, just as you intend!"

oṃ padma jvala hūṃ dhṛka

As soon as one has recited the seven-syllable mantra a hundred thousand times, one will obtain the samādhi called Stainless Lotus, Free of Obscuration, Pure. By obtaining that samādhi, one's body will blaze brilliantly, and there will be light rays of many colors. One will abide on the seventh ground. The radiance of one's body will illuminate the abodes of all the buddha fields in the great trichiliocosm. Wherever the many kinds of blazing jewel light rays fall, all kinds of rains of flowers will arise, and offerings will be made to the tathāgatas. Then the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Blazing Stainless Light Rays, golden in color, will extend his arm, place his right hand on the crown of the vidyādhara's head, give him the word "Excellent," and reassure him, saying: "Vidyādhara, excellent, excellent! This rite of reciting the secret heart of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is the supreme offering."

"This is the true heart of the maṇḍala called the Secret Heart of noble Avalokiteśvara, Amoghapāśa Padmoṣṇīṣa. Vidyādhara, now that you have accomplished the whole and complete maṇḍala, the detailed rite of the heart of Padmoṣṇīṣa, and the emanation into the heart of Amoghapāśa, go to the buddha field of the vidyādharas and perform the deeds of a buddha!"

oṃ amogha maṇi padme

If one recites this eight-syllable heart of the dhāraṇī a hundred thousand times, one's body will become utterly pure and stainless. Merely by reciting it, one becomes utterly pure inside and out, like the precious jewel, the fire crystal. In this way the vidyādhara's body becomes completely pure, and he will come to abide on the eighth ground. The bodhisattva, the great being, noble Avalokiteśvara, will reveal his own completely pure body in the very nature of his own form, and standing before the vidyādhara, he will fully reassure him. He will place his right hand on the crown of his head and give him the word "Excellent," saying: "Vidyādhara, excellent, excellent! Vidyādhara, you have entered into joy with superior intention. Vidyādhara, come here to behold the worlds in which the buddha fields are evenly interconnected! There you will perform the deeds of a buddha. Now that you have accomplished the heart of Amoghapāśa Padmoṣṇīṣa, the secret maṇḍala, carry out all the supreme practices, worldly and transcendent!"

oṃ padma locane huru hūṃ

Having recited this nine-syllable dhāraṇī-mantra a hundred thousand times, one will come to abide on the ninth ground and will become the foremost of the sons of noble Avalokiteśvara. Ninety-nine koṭi-niyutas of tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas will appear directly before the vidyādhara and will display the many kinds of emanations of the domain of the buddhas. All of them will place their hands on the crown of the vidyādhara's head and give him the word "Excellent," saying: "Great vidyādhara, excellent, excellent! You have well accomplished the work of toil and training. You have accomplished the practice for buddhahood, both worldly and transcendent. You have accomplished the practice of the detailed rite of the maṇḍala of Amoghapāśa, the practice together with the sūtras and the scriptures, and all that was taught by the Guide of the World."

oṃ padmoṣṇīṣa vimale hūṃ phaṭ

If one recites this ten-syllable secret mantra a hundred thousand times, one becomes irreversible and comes to abide on the tenth ground. The gods and the human beings will declare, "This is a tathāgata," and one becomes irreversible from unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. One will become a cakravartin of Amoghapāśa Padmoṣṇīṣa; have no doubt of this. Through the very reality of the practice of the ten-syllable secret mantra, this unsurpassed accomplishment is attained merely by reciting the emanation of the heart of

Amoghapāśa. With intense devotion to all that I have previously taught: being pure, practicing cleanliness, wearing clean clothes, having a mind of loving-kindness and compassion arisen in one, speaking the truth, showing respect to the guru, having great faith in the Three Jewels, and always making offerings to the guru and the master, this is the rite of recitation. It has been taught as the unsurpassed awakening of the buddhas.

Here ends the benefits and the rite of The Dhāraṇī of the Ten Grounds.

## Translator's Notes

• The buddha names "Banner of the Lotus Gaze" and "Blazing Stainless Light Rays" are translated from the Tibetan because I could not confidently identify their Sanskrit forms. The second could also be read as a description: "the Buddha, blazing with stainless light, golden in color."

In the fifth-ground passage, the Tibetan reads "spangs kyis bya ba thams cad kyis shig." I have taken this as the evident "spangs kyi(s) bya ba thams cad gyis shig," meaning "abandon ... and perform every rite." Rendering the instructional phrase as an imperative follows that reading.

"Koṭis of niyutas" renders bye ba khrag khrig, a vast number.

In the sixth-ground passage the Tibetan has don yod pa'i padma'i gtsug tor, without zhags pa. It is taken as an abbreviated form of the name Amoghapāśa Padmoṣṇīṣa and rendered "Amogha Padmoṣṇīṣa."

"Recited" for dran pa (lit. "recollect") follows the draft and refers to mental recitation.
• The number □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is a compound of very large numerical units (koṭi and niyuta-type orders of magnitude); it is rendered "koṭi-niyutas" rather than given an exact English figure. "Joy with superior intention" may also allude to the first bodhisattva ground, Pramuditā, "the Joyful".

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.